

Project XTC

Working Paper 005

Chapter 5 – The SELECT Button: The Heart of DrivenByMoss

If you remember only one control on the X-Touch, remember SELECT. Beginners often assume that the controller operates on whichever fader they touched most recently. In reality, DrivenByMoss is built around the concept of the selected track. That single idea explains a surprising amount of the controller's behaviour.

What SELECT Really Does

Pressing SELECT tells Bitwig, 'this is the track I want to work on.' The selected track becomes the focus for many operations, including device editing, browser interaction, remote controls and parameter pages. Changing the selected track changes the target of those operations, even though the physical controls remain exactly the same.

Workflow Example

Imagine you have a project containing a drum bus, bass, pads and lead synth. To edit the lead synth's filter cutoff:

1. Press SELECT on the lead track.
2. Press DEVICE.
3. Turn the appropriate V-Pot.

Notice that you never had to touch the mouse. Once you start thinking 'Select → Mode → Adjust', the X-Touch becomes far more predictable.

Why?

SELECT is the bridge between the hardware and Bitwig's current focus. Rather than the controller guessing what you intend to edit, you make that decision explicitly. This reduces accidental edits and makes navigation scalable even in very large projects.

Common Mistake

'I'm turning the encoder but the wrong device is changing.'

Nine times out of ten the cause is simple: the wrong track is selected. Before checking MIDI connections or restarting Bitwig, glance at the selected channel on the X-Touch and in Bitwig.

Exercise

Create a project with four instrument tracks. Select each track in turn and enter Device mode. Observe how the scribble strips and encoder assignments change while the physical controls stay exactly where they are. This is one of the defining characteristics of the MCU workflow.